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NEWSPAPER

26th December, 2018

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52nd WEEK



UN VOTE ON JERUSALEM

UPSC CSE – GS II

GS II ... EFFECT OF POLICIES AND POLITICS OF DEVELOPED AND DEVELOPING COUNTRIES ON INDIA'S INTERESTS. IMPORTANT INTERNATIONAL INSTITUTIONS, AGENCIES AND THEIR STRUCTURE, MANDATE.



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NEWSPAPER EDITORIALS

... DISCUSSION

26th DECEMBER, 2017

A capital mistake

The U.S.'s pressure tactics on the Jerusalem vote marked a new low at the United Nations



CHINMAYA R. GHAREKHAN

What the world witnessed in the past few days at the United Nations, on a resolution demanding that the U.S. rescind its recognition of Jerusalem as the capital of Israel, was an unprecedented display of the arrogance of power. Never before in the history of the UN has a member state threatened, so publicly and so inelegantly, fellow member states with dire consequences if they did not fall in line with its position as the U.S. did. It should not come as a surprise if in the coming weeks and months the U.S. loses an election to one of the UN organisations, just as Britain lost its bid to a seat on the International Court of Justice, and for the same reason. The member states are not willing to put up any longer with the hubris of the Permanent Five.

A contentious issue

The Jerusalem issue is easily the most contentious one between the

the Palestinians and the Israelis. There are other issues such as borders, sharing of waters, refugees, security, and so on. None of them is amenable to easy answers, but the Jerusalem problem is the most sensitive. Any attempt to unilaterally change its status will kill the peace process.

U.S. President Donald Trump has obviously given priority to nourishing his core domestic constituency rather than worry about the concerns of his close allies, all of whom voted against the U.S., except Canada – though it did not side with its powerful neighbour and simply abstained.

The immediate international reaction to Mr. Trump's decision on Jerusalem was rather muted. Instead of condemning it, most voiced concern at the negative impact it would have on the peace process. Even several Arab countries were not very vocal in their criticism. But soon, the Arab street asserted itself and forced the governments to take a more robust position. Egypt seems to have played a lead role in this. It drafted a resolution which avoided mentioning the U.S. by name; that would have made it difficult for Britain and others to support the



draft. After the veto in the Security Council, Egypt and Turkey lost no time in bringing the matter to an emergency session of the General Assembly, where there is no veto.

In all, 172 member states cast their votes. This means 21 countries did not vote at all. A few of them seem to have lost their right to vote because of arrears in payment of their mandatory dues to the organisation. The resolution passed with 128 votes in favour, a comfortable two-thirds majority. Nine voted against, and 35 abstained. The U.S. threat might have worked both ways.

It would be interesting to watch how the presidential threat works out in practice in the case of Pakistan which voted against the U.S. Among India's neighbours, Bhutan abstained. This might be explained either by its desire to de-

monstrate its independence from India or not to alienate the U.S., or perhaps a combination of the two.

Tilting the vote

India's vote in favour of the resolution was in line with its traditional policy. In recent months, there has been a noticeable change in the formulation of Indian statements on the Palestine problem, with the phrase 'East Jerusalem' being absent. This had given rise to a doubt about India's vote in the General Assembly. It is probable that India was in any case going to vote in favour of the Egyptian draft, given its need not to antagonise the entire Muslim world. The American ultimatums might just have tilted the balance. The government, no doubt, analysed the cost-benefit ratio. India's vote would have disappointed Israel and the U.S. It has excellent relations with Israel, as ought to be. But an objective analysis suggests that it is Israel which needs India more than the other way around. India buys at least a third of Israel's defence production. India is also very important to Israel for diplomatic and political reasons. Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu will not cancel his forthcoming visit to India.

As for the U.S., the interest is more mutual. We need American support for a few things such as the sale of their defence platforms and membership of the Nuclear Suppliers Group. The U.S. has a huge interest in India's markets, especially given the latter's insatiable desire to acquire, and almost limitless capacity to pay for, expensive military hardware. There is also the China factor. But since Mr. Trump has very recently described India as a leading global power and expressed his readiness to support it in reaching that status, India can perhaps relax. It is fortunate since it is not dependent on American aid, which can be cut off or reduced at will.

Noteworthy has been the silence of the Muslim community in India, judging from the electronic and English language print media. Jerusalem has always been a 'red line' issue for them. The government would be justified in drawing its own conclusions from the relative absence of a Muslim reaction to the U.S. move.

Chinmaya R. Gharekhan is a former Permanent Representative and Under-Secretary-General at the United Nations.

This year, on Jerusalem

India's vote at the UN is in line with its leading power ambitions, and not just a legacy of nonalignment



VARUN R. GEORGE

When India voted on a UN General Assembly (UNGA) resolution last week on the status of Jerusalem, going against the wishes of the U.S. and Israel, many observers of its foreign policy were surprised. The resolution did not make a direct reference to the recent U.S. decision to recognise Jerusalem as the capital of Israel and shift its embassy to the holy city from Tel Aviv. Through the resolution adopted with 128 in favour to nine against, with 35 abstentions, the 193 member UNGA expressed "deep regret" over "recent decisions concerning the status of Jerusalem" and stressed that Jerusalem "is a final status issue to be resolved through negotiations in the with relevant U.S. resolutions," between Israel and Palestine.

India's stand

The surprise over the Indian vote was not because it fell out of line with the country's foreign policy as we have known it, but because of an apparent deviation from Prime Minister Narendra Modi's new strategic thinking. Much has been written on the 'Modi strategic doctrine' but the concept has been briefly summarised by Mr. Modi himself and explained by Foreign Secretary S. Jaishankar on earlier occasions – the goal is to transform India from being a 'balancing power' to a 'leading power' on the international stage. U.S. President Donald Trump's National Security Strategy issued recently offers support for this aspiration of India to emerge as a 'leading power'.



India's Jerusalem vote can be interpreted as a continuing adherence to its traditional policy of nonalignment. But a more appropriate interpretation of the vote is possible within the framework of India's leading power ambitions. To do that, we need to also see the vote in conjunction with two other votes in the recent past at the UN. The first was in June, when India supported a move by Mauritius to take its sovereignty claim over the British-controlled Chagos Archipelago in the Indian Ocean to the International Court of Justice (ICJ), against the wishes of the U.S.; the second was in November when it did not vote on the ICJ, in spite of active opposition from the U.S.

On the Jerusalem vote in the UNGA, which is not binding, if India had voted against the resolution, it would have ended up in the company of seven countries that joined the U.S. and Israel. These are: Guatemala, Honduras, the Marshall Islands, Micronesia, Palau, Palau and Tuvalu, the combined population of which roughly equals the population of India. In the 2012 General Assembly election, Mr. Modi won more votes in the Mauritius constituency than the population of four of those countries. Not exactly the group that India might want to lead, as second deputy after America and Israel.

The second option was to abstain. Supporters of the 'leading power' doctrine often argue, rightly, that India must be more forthright and articulate in expressing its position on issues confronting the world. As it did, for instance, by speaking up on the debt and trade initiative. So, abstaining was not an attractive option for an aspiring leading power.

Many advantages Suboptimal as it might be as a choice, voting for the resolution put India in the company of the overwhelming majority of the world. It kept India in the company of Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO) and BRICS (Brazil, Russia, India, China, South Africa), groupings that India continues to value under the Modi government. While BRICS and the

SCO stayed together, the American-led NATO split on the issue, and even the Five Eyes countries of the English-speaking West – Australia, Canada, New Zealand, the U.K. and the U.S. – did not stay together on this vote. And India has far more significant interests in West Asian peace and stability than many of these countries. South Korea and Japan, treaty allies of the U.S. in the midst of a nuclear threat from North Korea, also voted for the resolution. Yes, India voted alongside Pakistan, but that happens often often. Some critics of the Indian vote have said Islamic countries do not support India on Kashmir. In 2016, Pakistan raised Kashmir's case at the U.N. in 2017, seven times, a total of 90 times. There are 17 countries in the Organisation of Islamic Cooperation, and statistically, there were 92 chances for a statement against India on Kashmir over the last two years by an Islamic country. But it has not happened even once.

While India under Mr. Modi's brand of Hinduva nationalism is seeking leadership status on the global stage, the U.S. under Mr. Trump is undergoing a transition from being a hegemon to being a bully in its leadership role. The Jerusalem decision itself and the rhetoric that preceded the UNGA vote is a stark demonstration of this new U.S. posture. The disruptive attack on Mr. Trump opens new possibilities for India's leading power ambitions, but that can be achieved by wisely following American diplomats. The Chagos Archipelago vote in June and India's UNGA vote in November bear out that fact.

Mauritius wanted the UNGA to request the ICJ to issue an advisory opinion on its sovereignty claim over the archipelago as it considers it an unfulfilled agenda of decolonisation. The U.S. recognises U.K. sovereignty over the territory and

they jointly operate the Diego Garcia military base there. India voted in support of the resolution, overruling the fear of a bilateral dispute being taken to ICJ. "The process of decolonisation that started with our own independence, still remains unfinished seven decades later," India's Permanent Representative to the UN, Syed Abulhasan, said in a statement on India's vote. The resolution was passed with 94 countries voting in favour, 11 against and 87 abstaining.

In November, the U.S. supported the U.K. in its contest against India for an ICJ seat, as did all other permanent members of the Security Council. India stood to ground and won the day as the UNGA overwhelmingly supported it, forcing other permanent members to limit their support to the U.S., which finally withdrew its candidature. It is not difficult to draw a link between the two votes.

Leading power ambitions are not realised by declaring unimpeachable allegiances to anyone. If you are serious about this, it must be met with the caveat that any resemblance is purely coincidental and not intended. If you are worried that this might make the U.S. unhappy towards India, be assured, not any more unhappy than it can be towards the U.S. that voted against it – after all, the U.S. had voted for it in the ICJ election against India. And the vote is only as much an upshot of the increasingly marginalised status of India, as Japan's vote for the resolution can be an upshot of its 100,000-strong diaspora. Three UNGA votes over six months are more about multilateral diplomacy coming of age. India can be great friends with the U.S. and Israel and still disagree with them on some issues.

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Affirmative vote

The U.S. must heed the UN resolution and reconsider its Jerusalem move

The UN General Assembly vote on a resolution calling for the final settlement of Jerusalem through negotiations may have been pitched as a contest between Israel and Palestine; however, it became a referendum on U.S. President Donald Trump's decision to recognise the city as Israel's capital. The final outcome should force the U.S. to rethink its move, with 128 of the UNGA's 193 member countries voting for the resolution, and only nine against it. Among those voting for the resolution that "deeply regretted" the U.S. decision were its NATO allies, Germany, the U.K. and France, its Asian allies Japan and South Korea; its closest neighbours Canada and Mexico chose merely to abstain. The overwhelming majority ignored Mr. Trump and his UN Ambassador Nikki Haley's threats that all countries that defied America would be 'named and shamed' and face cancellation of U.S. aid. The suggestion was that the U.S. would exact its revenge by refusing to support these countries when they next need it at the UN. Israel showed deep derision for the world body, which Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu referred to as a "house of lies", while his UN envoy called the 128 countries "puppets forced to dance". Such threats and epithets mark new lows in international diplomacy, and Israel and the U.S. come away looking like childish bullies for issuing them. With all its weaknesses, the UN is a global collective, and it is imperative to acknowledge its mandate when such a large number of nations speak in one voice. The U.S. only recently asserted its intention to uphold the international rules-based order in its National Security Strategy document. It cannot now just walk away from both UN resolutions and its national commitment to the Israel-Palestine peace process by unilaterally changing its stand on the status of Jerusalem, without being accused of doublespeak.

By voting for the resolution, India has affirmed its traditional policy in favour of a negotiated settlement for Jerusalem as part of a larger two-state solution for Israel and Palestine. Although Prime Minister Narendra Modi avoided mentioning the contours of the settlement during his visit to Jerusalem in July this year, India's support to the creation of a Palestinian state according to UN Resolution 181 (1948) was heavily underscored in his statement to the UN in November, just days before Mr. Trump's decision. There had been some speculation that in the face of the U.S. threats over the resolution, as well as Mr. Netanyahu's impending visit to India in January, India would dilute its support to those principles in favour of close strategic ties with both nations. In choosing to vote for the resolution at the UNGA, India has shown a clarity of purpose that also aligns with the broad global consensus.

1 A capital mistake - Chinmaya R. Gharekhan

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What the world witnessed in the past few days at the United Nations, on a resolution demanding that the U.S. rescind its recognition of Jerusalem as the capital of Israel, was an unprecedented display of the arrogance of power. Never before in the history of the UN has a member state threatened, so publicly and so inelegantly, fellow member states with dire consequences if they did not fall in line with its position as the U.S. did. It should not come as a surprise if in the coming weeks and months the U.S. loses an election to one of the UN organisations, just as Britain lost its bid to a seat on the International Court of Justice, and for the same reason. The member states are not willing to put up any longer with the hubris of the Permanent Five.

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The Jerusalem issue is easily the most contentious one between the the Palestinians and the Israelis. There are other issues such as borders, sharing of waters, refugees, security, and so on. None of them is amenable to easy answers, but the Jerusalem problem is the most sensitive. Any attempt to unilaterally change its status will kill the peace process.

1 A capital mistake - Chinmaya R. Gharekhan

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The immediate international reaction to Mr. Trump's decision on Jerusalem was rather muted. Instead of condemning it, most voiced concern at the negative impact it would have on the peace process. Even several Arab countries were not very vocal in their criticism. But soon, the Arab street asserted itself and forced the governments to take a more robust position. Egypt seems to have played a lead role in this. It drafted a resolution which avoided mentioning the U.S. by name; that would have made it difficult for Britain and others to support the draft. After the veto in the Security Council, Egypt and Turkey lost no time in bringing the matter to an emergency session of the General Assembly, where there is no veto.

In all, 172 member states cast their votes. This means 21 countries did not vote at all. A few of them seem to have lost their right to vote because of arrears in payment of their mandatory dues to the organisation. The resolution passed with 128 votes in favour, a comfortable two-thirds majority. Nine voted against, and 35 abstained. The U.S. threat might have worked both ways.

It would be interesting to watch how the presidential threat works out in practice in the case of Pakistan which voted against the U.S. Among India's neighbours, Bhutan abstained. This might be explained either by its desire to demonstrate its independence from India or not to alienate the U.S., or perhaps a combination of the two.

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Noteworthy has been the silence of the Muslim community in India, judging from the electronic and English language print media. Jerusalem has always been a 'red line' issue for them. The government would be justified in drawing its own conclusions from the relative absence of a Muslim reaction to the U.S. move.



1 This year, on Jerusalem

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India's vote at the UN is in line with its leading power ambitions, and not just a legacy of nonalignment

When India voted on a UN General Assembly (UNGA) resolution last week on the status of Jerusalem, going against the wishes of the U.S. and Israel, many observers of its foreign policy were surprised. The resolution did not make a direct reference to the recent U.S. decision to recognise Jerusalem as the capital of Israel and shift its embassy to the holy city from Tel Aviv. Through the resolution adopted with 128 in favour to nine against, with 35 abstentions, the 193-member UNGA expressed "deep regret" over "recent decisions concerning the status of Jerusalem" and stressed that Jerusalem "is a final status issue to be resolved through negotiations in line with relevant U.N. resolutions," between Israel and Palestine.

India's stand

The surprise over the Indian vote was not because it fell out of line with the country's foreign policy as we have known it, but because of an apparent deviation from Prime Minister Narendra Modi's new strategic thinking. Much has been written on the 'Modi strategic doctrine' but the concept has been pithily summarised by Mr. Modi himself and explained by Foreign Secretary S. Jaishankar on earlier occasions — the goal is to transform India from being a 'balancing power' to a 'leading power' on the international stage. U.S. President Donald Trump's National Security Strategy released recently offers support for this aspiration of India to emerge as a 'leading power.'

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India's Jerusalem vote can be interpreted as a continuing adherence to its traditional policy of nonalignment. But a more appropriate interpretation of the vote is possible within the framework of India's leading power ambitions. To do that, we need to also see the vote in conjunction with two other votes in the recent past at the UN. The first was in June, when India supported a move by Mauritius to take its sovereignty claims over the British-controlled Chagos Archipelago in the Indian Ocean to the International Court of Justice (ICJ), against the wishes of the U.S.; the second was in November when India won a seat on the ICJ, in spite of active opposition from the U.S.

On the Jerusalem vote in the UNGA, which is not binding, if India had voted against the resolution, it would have ended up in the company of seven countries that joined the U.S. and Israel. These are Guatemala, Honduras, the Marshall Islands, Micronesia, Nauru, Palau and Togo, the combined population of which roughly equals the population of Delhi. In the 2012 Gujarat Assembly election, Mr. Modi won more votes in the Maninagar constituency than the population of four of these countries. Not exactly the group that India might want to lead, as second deputy after America and Israel.

The second option was abstaining, along with Antigua-Barbuda, Argentina, Australia, Bahamas, Benin, Canada, Cameroon, Croatia, Haiti, etc.

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Of these, Canada, which used to vote with the U.S. on Israel resolutions, moved away from the U.S. position this time. Canada and Mexico also face the threat of the dismantling of the North American Free Trade Agreement by the Trump administration. As for Australia, its interests in West Asia are hardly comparable to India's. In any case, not taking a position on an issue is hardly worthy of an aspiring leader.

Supporters of the 'leading power' doctrine often argue, rightly, that India must be more forthright and articulate in expressing its position on issues confronting the world. As it did, for instance, by speaking up on the Belt and Road Initiative. So, abstaining was not an attractive option for an aspiring leading power.

Many advantages

Suboptimal as it might be as a choice, voting for the resolution put India in the company of the overwhelming majority of the world. It kept India in the company of Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO) and BRICS (Brazil, Russia, India, China, South Africa), groupings that India continues to value under the Modi government. While BRICS and the SCO stayed together, the American-led NATO split on the issue, and even the Five Eyes countries of the English-speaking West — Australia, Canada, New Zealand, the U.K. and the U.S. — did not stay together on this vote. And India has far more significant interests in West Asian peace and stability than many of these countries.

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Date :26th December, 2017

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South Korea and Japan, treaty allies of the U.S. in the midst of a nuclear threat from North Korea, also voted for the resolution. Yes, India voted alongside Pakistan, but that happens quite often. Some critics of the Indian vote have said Islamic countries do not support India on Kashmir. In 2016, Pakistan raised Kashmir nine times at the U.N.; in 2017, seven times, a total of 16 times. There are 57 countries in the Organisation of Islamic Cooperation, and statistically, there were 912 chances for a statement against India on Kashmir over the last two years by an Islamic country. But it has not happened even once.

While India under Mr. Modi's brand of Hindutva nationalism is seeking leadership status on the global stage, the U.S. under Mr. Trump is undergoing a transition from being a hegemon to being a bully in its leadership role. The Jerusalem decision itself and the rhetoric that preceded the UNGA vote is a stark demonstration of this new U.S. posture. The disruptive streak in Mr. Trump opens new possibilities for India's leading power ambitions, but that cannot be achieved by blindly following American diktats. The Chagos Archipelago vote in June and India's ICJ contest in November bear out that fact.

Mauritius wanted the UNGA to request the ICJ to issue an advisory opinion on its sovereignty claim over archipelago as it considers it as an unfinished agenda of decolonisation. The U.S. recognises U.K. sovereignty over the territory and they jointly operate the Diego Garcia military base there. India voted in support of the resolution, overcoming the fear of a bilateral dispute being taken to ICJ. "The process of decolonisation that started with our own independence, still remains unfinished seven decades later," India's Permanent Representative to the UN, Syed Akbaruddin, said in a statement on India's vote. The resolution was passed with 94 countries voting in favour, 15 against and 65 abstaining.

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Leading power ambitions are not realised by declaring unquestioning allegiance to anyone. If you see Nehruvian thinking in this script, it must be read with the caveat that any resemblance is purely coincidental and not intended. If you are worried that this might make the U.S. unhappy towards India, be assured, not any more unhappy than it can be towards the U.K. that voted against it — after all, the U.S. had voted for it in the ICJ election against India. And the vote is only as much an appeasement of the increasingly marginalised Muslims of India, as Japan's vote for the resolution can be an appeasement of its 100,000-strong Muslims. Three UNGA votes over six months are more about multilateral diplomacy coming of age. India can be great friends with the U.S. and Israel and still disagree with them on some issues.

Date :23rd December, 2017

1 Affirmative vote

The U.S. must heed the UN resolution and reconsider its Jerusalem move

The UN General Assembly vote on a resolution calling for the final settlement of Jerusalem through negotiations may have been pitched as a contest between Israel and Palestine; however, it became a referendum on U.S. President Donald Trump's decision to recognise the city as Israel's capital. The final outcome should force the U.S. to rethink its move, with 128 of the UNGA's 193 member-countries voting for the resolution, and only nine against it. Among those voting for the resolution that "deeply regretted" the U.S. decision were its NATO allies, Germany, the U.K. and France, its Asian allies Japan and South Korea; its closest neighbours Canada and Mexico chose merely to abstain. The overwhelming majority ignored Mr. Trump and his UN Ambassador Nikki Haley's threats that all countries that defied America would be 'named and shamed' and face cancellation of U.S. aid. The suggestion was that the U.S. would exact its revenge by refusing to support these countries when they next need it at the UN. Israel showed deep derision for the world body, which Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu referred to as a "house of lies", while his UN envoy called the 128 countries "puppets forced to dance". Such threats and epithets mark new lows in international diplomacy, and Israel and the U.S. come away looking like churlish bullies for issuing them. With all its weaknesses, the UN is a global collective, and it is imperative to acknowledge its mandate when such a large number of nations speak in one voice. The U.S. only recently asserted its intention to uphold the international rules-based order in its National Security Strategy document. It cannot now just walk away from both UN resolutions and its national commitment to the Israel-Palestine peace process by unilaterally changing its stand on the status of Jerusalem, without being accused of doublespeak.

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This year, on Jerusalem

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VARGHESE K. GEORGE

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Of these, Canada, which used to vote with the U.S. on Israel resolutions, moved away from the U.S. position this time. Canada and Mexico also face the threat of the dismantling of the North American Free Trade Agreement by the Trump administration. As for Australia, its interests in West Asia are hardly comparable to India's. In any case, not taking a position on an issue is hardly worthy of an aspiring leader.

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South Korea and Japan, treaty allies of the U.S. in the midst of a nuclear threat from North Korea, also voted for the resolution. Yes, India voted alongside Pakistan, but that happens quite often. Some critics of the Indian vote have said Islamic countries do not support India on Kashmir. In 2016, Pakistan raised Kashmir nine times at the U.N.; in 2017, seven times, a total of 16 times. There are 57 countries in the Organisation of Islamic Cooperation, and statistically, there were 912 chances for a statement against India on Kashmir over the last two years by an Islamic country. But it has not happened even once.

While India under Mr. Modi's brand of Hindutva nationalism is seeking leadership status on the global stage, the U.S. under Mr. Trump is undergoing a transition from being a hegemon to being a bully in its leadership role. The Jerusalem decision itself and the rhetoric that preceded the UNGA vote is a stark demonstration of this new U.S. posture. The disruptive streak in Mr. Trump opens new possibilities for India's leading power ambitions, but that cannot be achieved by blindly following American dictats. The Chagos Archipelago vote in June and India's ICJ contest in November bear out that fact.

Mauritius wanted the UNGA to request the ICJ to issue an advisory opinion on its sovereignty claims over archipelago as it considers it as an unfinished agenda of decolonisation. The U.S. recognises U.K. sovereignty over the territory and

they jointly operate the Diego Garcia military base there. India voted in support of the resolution, overcoming the fear of a bilateral dispute being taken to ICJ. "The process of decolonisation that started with our own independence, still remains unfinished seven decades later," India's Permanent Representative to the UN, Syed Akbaruddin, said in a statement on India's vote. The resolution was passed with 94 countries voting in favour, 15 against and 65 abstaining.

In November, the U.S. supported the U.K. in its contest against India for an ICJ seat, as did all other permanent members of the Security Council. India stood its ground and won the day as the UNGA overwhelmingly supported it, forcing other permanent members to limit their support to the U.K., which finally withdrew its candidature. It is not difficult to draw a link between the two votes.

Leading power ambitions are not realised by declaring unquestioning allegiance to anyone. If you see Nehruvian thinking in this script, it must be read with the caveat that any resemblance is purely coincidental and not intended. If you are worried that this might make the U.S. unhappy towards India, be assured, not any more unhappy than it can be towards the U.K. that voted against it – after all, the U.S. had voted for it in the ICJ election against India. And the vote is only as much an appeasement of the increasingly marginalised Muslims of India, as Japan's vote for the resolution can be an appeasement of its 100,000-strong Muslims. Three UNGA votes over six months are more about multilateral diplomacy coming of age. India can be great friends with the U.S. and Israel and still disagree with them on some issues.

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IMPORTANT QUESTION

ESSAY / MAINS / GD / INTERVIEWS

India's vote in various UN resolutions clearly points to a new era in the multi-lateral diplomacy for India. Critically examine.

CURRENT AFFAIRS



ISRAEL-PALESTINE CONFLICT



27th WEEK 2017

UPSC

CAPSULE - 2

ALL EXAMS

3rd July to 9th July, 2017



NEWS REPORT

- 128 members out of UN General Assembly's, 193 member countries voted for the resolution calling for the final settlement of the Jerusalem through the negotiations.
- 9 voted against it. Among those voting for the resolution are Germany, UK, France and its Asian allies Japan and South Korea.
- Canada and Mexico chose to abstain.

This happened in spite of America's threat that all the countries that defied America would be "named and shamed" and face the cancellation of US aid.



WHAT IS THE FINAL POSITION?

- 1 172 out of 193 member states cast their votes.
- 2 21 countries did not vote at all.
- 3 Some of them might have lost their right, because of arrears in payment of their dues to the Organisation.
- 4 128 votes in favour, 9 voted against and 35 abstained

Bhutan abstained, which may be due to its desire to demonstrate its independent policy from India or not to antagonise the US.



Benjamin Netanyahu
PM, Israel

NEW LOW IN INTERNATIONAL DIPLOMACY

- Benjamin Netanyahu, the Prime Minister of Israel referred to as a “house of lies”.
- UN envoy called the 128 countries “puppets forced to dance”.

WHAT ARE THE MAIN ISSUES PERTAINING TO THE SOLUTION FOR PALESTINE CONFLICT?



- Status of Jerusalem
- Settling the borders and Palestine wants contiguous territory
- What will happen to the refugees?
- Issues pertaining to sharing of waters and other minor aspects.



Cyprus

Mediterranean Sea

SYRIA

LEBANON

IRAQ

WEST BANK

JERUSALEM

JORDAN

EGYPT

SAUDI ARABIA

Gulf of Aqaba

Palestinian Loss of Land 1946 to 2000

Palestinian & Jewish Land 1946



UN Partition Plan 1947



1949 - 1967



2000



WHAT ARE THE SEVEN COUNTRIES THAT JOINED US AND ISRAEL BY VOTING AGAINST THE RESOLUTION?



- Guatemala
- Honduras
- Marshall Islands
- Micronesia
- Nauru
- Palau
- Togo

The combined population of the above 7 countries roughly equals the population of Delhi.



INDIA'S VOTE... AFFIRMATION OF TRADITIONAL POLICY

- 1** It is accepted negotiated settlement for Jerusalem as part of two state solution.
- 2** India's support to the creation of a Palestinian State according to UN Resolution 181 (1948), is already there.
- 3** By choosing this vote, India has shown a clarity of purpose, that also aligns with broad global consensus.
- 4** India's decision probably, is also not to antagonise the entire Muslim World.

SOME OF THE COUNTRIES THAT ABSTAINED



- Argentina
- Australia
- Canada
- Bahamas

Normally Canada, which used to vote with the US, moved away from the US position this time as it faced the threat of dismantling the NAFTA.



The Five Eyes, often abbreviated as FVEY, is an intelligence alliance comprising Australia, Canada, New Zealand, the United Kingdom and the United States.

SPLIT OF THE AMERICAN FRONTS

- 1** The American led NATO was split on the issue.
- 2** Even the Five Eyes countries of the English-speaking region ie., Australia, Canada, New Zealand, U.K. and U.S. did not stay together.
- 3** South Korea and Japan, who are facing nuclear threat from North Korea also voted for the resolution.

HOW US AND ISRAEL WILL SEE INDIA'S DECISION?

LIVE

- 1 If we analyse objectively, it is Israel, which needs India more than other way round.
- 2 India buys at least a third of Israel's defence production.
- 3 With USA, the interest is more mutual. We need support for few things, such as sale of defence platforms and membership to NSG.
- 4 US has a huge interest in Indian markets. They badly need markets like India for their expensive military hardware.
- 5 China factor will also make America's position vis-à-vis India stronger. This was announced by America in its NSS recently, that India is a leading global power.

INDIA AND RECENT STANCES

ISSUE NO. 1

India supported a move by Mauritius to take its sovereignty claims over the British-controlled Chagos Archipelago in the Indian Ocean to the ICJ, much against the wishes of USA.



ISSUE NO. 2

India won a seat on the ICJ, against active opposition from the U.S.



ISSUE NO. 3

India now voted against USA





For India, the multilateral diplomacy is coming of age. India can be great friends with the U.S. and Israel and can still disagree with them on some issues.

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SINCERE THANKS
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